

Grad Cafe SQL Query Results

1. How many entries applied for Fall 2026?

Answer: 31449

Query used: `SELECT COUNT(*) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026';`

Why this query: Counts every applicant row whose start term is exactly Fall 2026.

2. What percentage of entries are international students?

Answer: 46.57

Query used: `SELECT ROUND( 100.0 * COUNT(*) FILTER ( WHERE us_or_international NOT IN ('American', 'Other') ) / NULLIF(COUNT(*), 0), 2 ) AS answer FROM applicants;`

Why this query: Divides entries not marked American or Other by the full table count.

3. What are the average GPA, GRE, GRE V, and GRE AW values?

Answer: GPA: 3.75, GRE Q: 263.61, GRE V: 161.24, GRE AW: 4.34

Query used: `SELECT ROUND(AVG(gpa)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gpa, ROUND(AVG(gre)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gre, ROUND(AVG(gre_v)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gre_v, ROUND(AVG(gre_aw)::numeric, 2) AS avg_gre_aw FROM applicants;`

Why this query: Uses AVG, which ignores NULL values, so only applicants who provided each metric contribute to that metric.

4. What is the average GPA of American students in Fall 2026?

Answer: 3.78

Query used: `SELECT ROUND(AVG(gpa)::numeric, 2) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026' AND us_or_international = 'American';`

Why this query: Filters to American Fall 2026 entries and averages non-missing GPA values.

5. What percent of Fall 2026 entries are acceptances?

Answer: 37.09

Query used: `SELECT ROUND( 100.0 * COUNT(*) FILTER (WHERE status = 'Accepted') / NULLIF(COUNT(*), 0), 2 ) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026';`

Why this query: Computes the accepted share among Fall 2026 entries.

6. What is the average GPA of accepted Fall 2026 applicants?

Answer: 3.76

Query used: `SELECT ROUND(AVG(gpa)::numeric, 2) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term = 'Fall 2026' AND status = 'Accepted';`

Why this query: Filters to accepted Fall 2026 entries and averages available GPAs.

7. How many entries applied to JHU for a master's degree in Computer Science?

Answer: 18

Query used: `SELECT COUNT(*) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE degree ILIKE 'Masters' AND program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND ( program ILIKE '%Johns Hopkins%' OR program ILIKE '%JHU%' );`

Why this query: Uses the downloaded program string to match JHU or Johns Hopkins, Computer Science, and Masters.

8. How many 2026 acceptances applied to Georgetown, MIT, Stanford, or Carnegie Mellon for a CS PhD?

Answer: 28

Query used: `SELECT COUNT(*) AS answer FROM applicants WHERE term ILIKE '%2026%' AND status = 'Accepted' AND degree ILIKE 'PhD' AND program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND (program ILIKE '%Georgetown University%' OR program ILIKE '%MIT%' OR program ILIKE '%Massachusetts Institute of Technology%' OR program ILIKE '%Stanford University%' OR program ILIKE '%Carnegie Mellon University%');`

Why this query: Uses downloaded fields to count accepted 2026 CS PhD entries at the requested universities.

9. Does question 8 change when using LLM generated fields?

Answer: Downloaded fields: 28; LLM fields: 28; result did not change.

Query used: `WITH downloaded_fields AS (SELECT COUNT(*) AS count FROM applicants WHERE term ILIKE '%2026%' AND status = 'Accepted' AND degree ILIKE 'PhD' AND program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND (program ILIKE '%Georgetown University%' OR program ILIKE '%MIT%' OR program ILIKE '%Massachusetts Institute of Technology%' OR program ILIKE '%Stanford University%' OR program ILIKE '%Carnegie Mellon University%')), llm_fields AS (SELECT COUNT(*) AS count FROM applicants WHERE term ILIKE '%2026%' AND status = 'Accepted' AND degree ILIKE 'PhD' AND`

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llm_generated_program ILIKE '%Computer Science%' AND ( llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Georgetown University%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%MIT%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Massachusetts Institute of Technology%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Stanford University%' OR llm_generated_university ILIKE '%Carnegie Mellon University%' ) ) SELECT downloaded_fields.count AS downloaded_count, llm_fields.count AS llm_count, downloaded_fields.count <> llm_fields.count AS changed FROM downloaded_fields, llm_fields;
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Why this query: Compares the downloaded-field count from question 8 with the same count using standardized LLM program and university fields.

10. Original question: What percentage of entries include applicant comments?

Answer: 47.71

Query used: SELECT ROUND(100.0 * COUNT(*) FILTER (WHERE comments IS NOT NULL AND LENGTH(TRIM(comments)) > 0) / NULLIF(COUNT(*), 0), 2) AS answer FROM applicants;

Why this query: Measures how often self-submitted rows include non-empty comments.

11. Original question: What are the most common applicant statuses?

Answer: Rejected: 21640; Accepted: 19497; Waitlisted: 4835; Interview: 4047

Query used: SELECT status, COUNT(*) AS count FROM applicants GROUP BY status ORDER BY count DESC, status LIMIT 5;

Why this query: Groups entries by decision status and returns the five most frequent statuses.